

Research Interview Write-Up

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I am S Gopika, a second-year engineering student with a strong interest in programming, problem-solving, and technology-driven research. I am highly motivated to explore how software development and logical thinking can be applied to solve real-world problems, especially through innovative and socially impactful solutions.

I have actively participated in hackathons and project-based learning experiences, which have helped me develop practical skills beyond classroom learning. One of my key projects is **MandiMart**, developed during the Tuteduethon hackathon. MandiMart is a web-based solution designed to help Indian street food vendors easily compare raw material prices from multiple suppliers and place orders efficiently. This project focused on solving real challenges faced by small vendors, such as price transparency and accessibility, and helped me understand problem analysis, user-centric design, and implementation.

I was also selected for the **Smart India Hackathon (SIH)** and successfully advanced to the second round. During SIH, my team developed an application called **ASHA Chatbot**, a child welfare chatbot designed to provide a safe space for students to express their fears, emotions, and concerns. The chatbot aimed to support emotional well-being and guide children with appropriate responses, highlighting my interest in using technology for social good.

In terms of technical skills, I have working knowledge of **Python, C, and Java**. I am currently strengthening my understanding of **Data Structures and Algorithms (DSA)** through consistent practice on LeetCode, which has improved my logical thinking and coding confidence. Alongside this, I am in the process of learning **Web Development**, focusing on building functional and user-friendly applications.

Recently, I completed an online **Web Development internship with Future Interns**. As part of this internship, I successfully completed two hands-on projects: creating a **personal portfolio website** and developing a functional **e-commerce website**. These projects helped me gain practical experience in frontend development, project structuring, and implementing real-world features, while also reinforcing the importance of clean and maintainable code.

I am keen on continuously learning programming concepts, exploring research-oriented problem statements, and applying my skills to meaningful projects. I am particularly interested in opportunities that allow me to grow technically, think analytically, and contribute to innovative research and development work.